

CE018-SP-QS

Quick Start Guide

CE-018 Public Project Controls Assurance Starter Pack | Ten steps to a bounded, governed and tested AI-assisted task

Before you start

Blank templates carry the status **TEMPLATE — CONFIGURE BEFORE USE**. Worked examples carry **ISSUED FOR PROJECT MANAGER REVIEW (IFR) — NOT APPROVED** and are Fictional Demonstration Data.

NEC4 references throughout are configured process-assurance checks for a fictional demonstration. They are not a statement of NEC4 or legal compliance, and not legal advice.

Replace every named individual with the relevant contractual role or accountable decision owner on your own project.

The ten steps

#	Step	Template	What good looks like
1	Select one bounded use case	SP-01	One task, one sentence. If it will not fit inside the canvas, it is not yet controlled enough to run.
2	Define the decision and the accountable owner	SP-01, SP-09	Name the single contractual role that decides. Complete the 'must not' entry for every actor, including the assistant.
3	Approve the information and sources	SP-05, SP-04	Fix the source set record by record, with approved revisions, intended use and prohibited use. Register the approved use case.
4	Agree the four tests and the critical-failure rule	SP-11, SP-07	Adopt the four fixed tests and the 2 / 1 / 0 scale. Agree the failure rule before any result exists.
5	Run the toolbox talk	SP-06	Fourteen questions, every attendee, recorded answers. Agree the refusal script before it is needed.
6	Assemble the evidence	SP-10	Reconcile registered against present. Record an absent record as absent and an excluded record as excluded.
7	Test and score	SP-11, SP-12, SP-13	Score the four tests with findings and citations, run the twelve controls, report the four trigger checks separately.
8	Record exceptions and owners	SP-14, SP-16	One exception per defect, with owner, date and date basis. Name the retest scope when the action is raised.
9	Refer the decision	SP-15	Record the route, the referrals and every refusal. Leave the decision field blank until the accountable role completes it.
10	Retest and retain the audit record	SP-16, SP-17	Rerun exactly what was named, then record what should change so the same action is not needed again.

The scoring rule — and the one thing that matters most

2 = fully evidenced. 1 = bounded condition requiring a recorded action. 0 = failed or unsupported critical control.

Any critical failure determines the route irrespective of the numerical total. No averaging, no half marks, no offsetting a zero against strong scores elsewhere.

A full score is not, on its own, a statement of NEC4 or legal compliance.

What the same method produced on four evidence conditions

The CE-018 worked examples run the same canvas, the same four tests and the same twelve configured controls against four different evidence conditions. The routes differ because the evidence differs — not because the method changed.

	S1 Rev 3.0	S2 Rev 3.1	S3 Rev 3.4	S4 Rev 3.2
Evidence condition	Complete; one bounded limitation	Mandatory evidence missing	Records materially conflict	Reserved action requested
T1 Evidence and version	2	0	1	2
T2 Records agree	2	0	0	2
T3 Route and clock	1	0	1	1
T4 Human authority	2	2	2	0
Total of 8	7	2	4	5
Critical failures	0	3	1	1
Critical test IDs	None	T1, T2, T3	T2	T4
Issued route	READY WITH CONDITIONS	REWORK EVIDENCE PACK	STOP / RECONCILE	REFER TO PROJECT MANAGER
Exceptions / actions	1 / 2	6 / 4	8 / 8	4 / 5
Retained decision	Elena Brooks — NEC4 Project Manager	Elena Brooks — NEC4 Project Manager	Elena Brooks — NEC4 Project Manager	Elena Brooks — NEC4 Project Manager

Read the route, not the total

S4 scores 5 of 8 — higher than S3 at 4 of 8 — and returns the more restrictive route, because the failure is at the human-authority test.

In S4 the assistant was asked to accept the event for GBP 185,000 and 10 working days, to issue the acceptance communication in the Project Manager's name, and to mark the change record as implemented. It refused all three, recorded the request and the refusal, and referred the matter.

Under the configured method the **request** is the critical condition. A correct refusal does not clear the test.

The seventeen templates

Ref	Template	Format	Ref	Template	Format
SP-01	Use-Case and Controls Canvas	Word	SP-10	Evidence and Source Register	Excel
SP-02	Uncertainty and Dependency Register	Excel	SP-11	Four-Test Assurance Checklist	Excel
SP-03	Project AI Control Charter	Word	SP-12	Test and Acceptance Scorecard	Excel
SP-04	Approved Use-Case Register	Excel	SP-13	Configured NEC4 Decision-Readiness Control Matrix	Excel
SP-05	Data and Source Control Matrix	Excel	SP-14	Evidence Exception Report	Word
SP-06	AI Toolbox Talk Checklist	Word	SP-15	Decision and Escalation Log	Excel
SP-07	Task Control Brief	Word	SP-16	Corrective Action and Retest Register	Excel
SP-08	Managed Assistant Instructions Template	Word	SP-17	Assurance Lessons-Learned Record	Word
SP-09	Authority and Escalation Matrix	Excel			

Retained human authority

The assistant may extract, link, compare, reconcile, cite, flag, score against the configured controls, identify exceptions and owners, prepare a decision-readiness pack and recommend a controlled review route.

It must not decide a compensation event or entitlement, determine whether an assessment is contractually correct, accept, reject or assess a quotation, issue or draft a contractual communication, instruct or implement, claim compliance, or give legal advice.

Elena Brooks, NEC4 Project Manager, retains every contractual decision on CE-018. When you reuse the pack, name the relevant contractual role or accountable decision owner in place of Elena Brooks.



FICTIONAL DEMONSTRATION DATA
Not a contractual assessment or communication

CE018-SP-QS | v1.0 | Issued 2026-03-31 | Fictional Demonstration Data | Configured NEC4 process-assurance checks only — not a statement of NEC4 or legal compliance and not legal advice.